

to tell Elizabeth he was retiring, and she gave a cozy farewell tea. Afterward, she washed the dishes with Mary. They all knew the Queen would never retire. Her role was for life.

In the 1950s, the Queen and Prince Philip had enjoyed nights out together “undercover,” at the movies or theater. By the 1970s, however, this was more difficult, since the Queen’s safety became a big concern. As always, she had a police



protection officer with her, but the threat was now not just from press cameras. Attacks from the IRA (Irish Republican Army) took place in Britain as a result of The Troubles.

THE TROUBLES

This was a conflict in Northern Ireland in the late 20th century. In 1921, Ireland had been split into the Irish Republic and Northern Ireland. Nationalists, who were mainly Catholic, wanted the island united. In Northern Ireland, most Protestants wanted to stay in the UK, and the Catholic minority faced discrimination. Violence from both sides broke out in Northern Ireland. Terrorism spread to British cities, with IRA bombings.